

Beacon Light Academy (BLA) Mobile App

Official User Manual & Troubleshooting Guide

Welcome to the official Beacon Light Academy Mobile App! We have designed this app from the ground up to ensure parents, students, and teachers stay seamlessly connected.

This guide will walk you through the app's core features and provide essential troubleshooting steps to ensure you never miss an important school update.

1. The "Offline-First" Advantage

The BLA App is built with a modern "offline-first" architecture. This means:

- **Instant Loading:** The moment you open the app, your Diaries, Correspondences, and Circulars load instantly from your phone's secure local memory—no waiting for loading spinners.
- **Auto-Sync:** Every time you open the app, it silently checks the school's servers in the background. If there is new data (like a new homework assignment or a fee update), it will automatically download it and update your screen.
- **Manual Refresh:** If you ever suspect you are looking at older data, simply tap the **"Refresh"** button at the bottom of your screen, or "pull down" on any list to force a manual sync with the school database.

2. Managing Multiple Students

If you have more than one child enrolled at Beacon Light Academy, you do not need separate accounts.

- Look at the top-right corner of your Dashboard.
 - Tap the **Student Dropdown Menu** to instantly switch between your children.
 - Your Diaries, Fee details, and Correspondences will instantly swap to show the selected child's data.
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3. Understanding Push Notifications

The school uses Push Notifications for urgent alerts, including unpredicted school closures, fee reminders, and daily diary updates. We utilize Google's Firebase infrastructure to ensure these messages are sent out instantly.

However, modern smartphones (especially Android devices) have very aggressive "Battery Saver" features. To save battery life, your phone might forcefully put the BLA App to sleep, which can prevent notifications from waking up your screen.

Troubleshooting: "I am not receiving notifications!"

If you suspect you are missing notifications, the issue is almost always tied to your phone's built-in battery optimizer. Please follow these three steps to fix it:

Step 1: Check Notification Permissions

1. Open your phone's native **Settings**.
2. Go to **Apps** (or App Management) -> **BLA App**.
3. Tap on **Notifications** and ensure they are toggled to "**Allowed**" or "On".

Step 2: Disable Aggressive Battery Optimization (Crucial) Brands like Xiaomi, Oppo, Vivo, Samsung, and Huawei often block background notifications to save power.

1. Go to **Settings** -> **Apps** -> **BLA App**.
2. Look for **Battery** or **Battery Usage**.
3. Change the setting from "Optimized" to "**Unrestricted**" or "**Don't Optimize**". (*This tells your phone to always let BLA notifications through*).

Step 3: Background Data

1. In the same BLA App settings menu, tap on **Mobile Data & Wi-Fi**.
2. Ensure "**Allow background data usage**" is turned ON.

Note: If your phone has been sitting untouched for several hours (Doze Mode) or is on "Power Saving Mode," notifications may be intentionally delayed by your device until you unlock your screen.

4. The Ultimate Safety Net

If your phone ever blocks a push notification due to battery settings, don't worry! Your data is never lost. Simply **open the BLA App**. The background sync engine will instantly bypass your phone's battery blockers, connect directly to the school, and pull down any notices, diaries, or fee challans you may have missed while the phone was asleep.

5. Secure Logout

If you ever need to hand your device to someone else, use the **Logout** button. Logging out securely deletes your specific device token from the school's servers, ensuring that the next person who logs into the app on that phone will not receive your private notifications.

6. FAQs

Q: My child was transferred to a new class, but the app is still showing their old classwork and timetable. How do I fix this? A: To ensure the app loads as fast as possible, it securely saves your child's profile to your device. If your child has recently been transferred to a new class or section for the current academic year, you will need to clear this saved data so the app can fetch the latest updates. Simply follow these steps:

1. Tap on the **Settings** icon located in the bottom navigation bar.
2. Select **Reset App Data**.
3. Log back into the app using your credentials. Your child's new class, timetable, and notices will now be properly synced!